

The Noble Sūtra of Parṇaśavarī

Āryaparnāśavarīsūtra · Toh 735 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་པར་ཤ་བ་རིམ་དོ།

Toh 735 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī or ritual text known in Tibetan as "Phags pa par na sha ba ri'i mdo" and in Sanskrit associated with the goddess Parṇaśavarī, a deity of healing closely connected with Avalokiteśvara and Amitābha. The text belongs to the broader category of dhāraṇī and averting ritual literature and centers on the invocation of Parṇaśavarī — a form of the "Leaf-clad Mountain Woman" — for protection against illness, fear, demonic interference, and various forms of calamity. It opens with homages to the Three Jewels, the buddha Amitābha, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, and Mahāsthāmaprāpta, before proceeding into a series of Sanskrit dhāraṇī formulas calling upon Parṇaśavarī's power to avert misfortune. As Toh 735 in the Kangyur, it is preserved among the collection's dhāraṇī texts, reflecting the canonical importance of such protective rituals in the Tibetan Buddhist tradition.

May virtue always increase,
and may health, too, be attained.

Here ends the Averting Ritual Called "The Noble Completely Victorious One."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Tathāgata, arhat, and perfectly complete buddha Amitābha.

Homage to the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World.

Homage to the great bodhisattva Mahāsthāmaprāpta.

Vāmane tvam namasyāmi tvam namasyāmi vāmane. Bhagavati piśāci
Parṇaśavarī viśācipāśa parśudhāriṇī. Yāni kāni cid bhayāny utpadyante. Yaḥ
kāścin mārayoḥ. Yaḥ kāścin mahāmārayoḥ. Ye kena cid upadravāḥ. Ye kecid
upāyāsāḥ. Ye kecid ādhyātmikā bhayāḥ. Ye kecid upasargasambaddhā
utpadyante. Sarvāṇi tāni. Sarvastas. Sarvatebālatā evaṃ tapādyante. Na
pañḍitataḥ. Tad anena satyena satyavacanena satyapākena. Tadyathā: Oṃ
jaḥ jāḥ jaḥ jāḥ ebhiṣaḥ. Pañḍita adhiṣṭhitair mantrapadaiḥ. Mama
sarvasattvānānam ca. Rakṣaṃ kuru paritrāṇaṃ kuru. Parigrahaṃ kuru.
Paripālanaṃ kuru. Śāntiṃ kuru svastyayanaṃ kuru. Daṇḍaparihāraṃ kuru.
Śastraparihāraṃ kuru. Yāvad vaṣidhūṣaṇaṃ kuru. Agniparihāraṃ kuru.
Udakaparihāraṃ kuru. Kakhoredacchedanaṃ kuru. Sīmābandhaṃ kuru.
Dharaṇībandhaṃ kuru. Tadyathā: Amite amite. Amitodbhave.

Amitasambhave. Asvate. Asvāstyamge. Māmara māmara. Māsara māsara. Śama praśama. Upasama sarvabyādhīnupasama sarva akālamṛtyūnupasama sarva nakṣatragrahadoṣānupasama. Sarvadiṣṭrīṇām coḥ sasama. Bhagavati Parṇaśabarī. Tyumna tyumna. Vityumna vityumna. Tuna tuna tumule svāhā. Oṃ gaure gandhāri caurī caṇḍāli mātamgi pukkāsi svāhā. Namaḥ sarvaśavarāṇām mahāśavarāṇām. Bhagavati piśāci Parṇaśabarī svāhā. Oṃ piśāci Parṇaśabarī hrīḥ jaḥ hūṃ phaṭ piśāci svāhā. Oṃ amḥkure maṃkure kurare Parṇaśabarī svāhā.

For black plague, one makes a string, recites over it one hundred and eight times, ties one hundred and eight knots, and, using a vessel on which the heart-essence of the mantra has been written, performs the recitation properly. Afterward, one washes the sick person, or a horse, ox, or other animal, with fragrant water, washes the finest of the herd as well, and ties this around its head — and it will be pacified.

Likewise, for harm that has come to water buffalo, sheep, and goats, one should write it on a slate-board. One fills a vase with clean water, recites the mantra one hundred and eight times over it, and bathes the animal — and it will be pacified.

In the early morning one goes to the deity of the livestock pen, makes an offering of incense, flowers, and a torma cake, fills a vase with water that has not been used for any worldly purpose, recites the mantra one hundred and eight times, and, at the gate of the livestock deity's pen, erects a door-frame. On that door-frame one writes the vidyā mantra in saffron ink on the leaf of an alder tree and affixes it to the top of the door-frame. One then drives all the livestock through that door-frame gate when they go out to pasture. Furthermore, one fills four vases with water, recites the mantra one hundred and eight times, and has four people scatter the water — and the livestock will be free of disease. Likewise, if this is done for seven days, all the epidemic illnesses will be pacified.

For human disease and livestock disease, one writes the mantra on birch bark, makes an offering, and affixes it to the top of a victory banner.

For fear of tigers, one recites the mantra onto a bell and then rings it.

For fear of sea-monsters (makaras), one recites the mantra on a garment; and for children, if the mantra is recited, snakes, mice, evil beings, and the like will all have their mouths bound.

On the battlefield, one recites the mantra on ashes, and —
— if one smears them on the head and neck, they ward off weapons.

If the mantra is recited one hundred and eight times onto a cord, that cord is tied to the sick person's bed. If a vase is consecrated with one hundred and eight recitations, one bathes with that water. The mantra is recited onto a cord worn on the wrist, which is then tied on — and from that, relief will come.

If one circumambulates a region reciting the mantra onto bells, drums, and conch shells, all obstructing forces will be dispersed and harm will be pacified.

If a brave hero has a vidyā-lance placed upon his forehead and weapons are hurled, enemies or warfare will be pacified.

Here ends the noble sūtra of Parṇaśavarī.

Translator's Notes

- The title "Parṇaśavarī" designates the goddess Parṇaśavarī, a well-known female protective deity in the Indian Buddhist tradition, associated with healing and the averting of epidemics. The name means roughly "she of the leaf-clad śabara tribe" and is kept in Sanskrit throughout, as it is a proper name.

The bulk of the passage consists of a Sanskrit dhāraṇī transcribed phonetically into Tibetan script. The romanization offered here is a best reconstruction; the Tibetan orthography reflects the conventions of its period and the original Sanskrit Indic spelling cannot always be recovered with certainty from the transcription alone. No attempt has been made to normalize the dhāraṇī against a critical Sanskrit edition, as the primary task here is faithful rendering of what the Tibetan transmits.

The term rendered "gate-frame" or "door-frame" translates a Tibetan compound meaning literally "threshold-frame" in the sense of an architectural threshold through which animals pass; the ritual purpose is to consecrate the passage of livestock through the apotropaic boundary.

The text ends mid-sentence, indicating this passage is an excerpt from a longer ritual manual.

- The text reads "བཤམ་པའི་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་" — literally "placing a vidyā-lance" on the forehead. This is a ritual gesture, likely involving a symbolic weapon or implement consecrated with the vidyā mantra of Parṇaśavarī; the exact physical procedure is not elaborated in the text.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please

consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.